

School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences

Sociology (BA)

Sociology offers a scientific approach to examining social groups, human interactions, and social change. Sociologists are interested in a wide range of topics and issues related to social life. Some examples of sociological questions include: Why do some groups have more resources and power than others in society and what explains these inequalities? What factors influence marriage and divorce rates? How do families, schools, churches, and corporations affect social control? What are the functions of welfare programs? How do cities grow and transform to reflect changing technologies and population trends? How does law interact with society and social institutions? What are the causes and consequences of crime and deviant behavior?

The mission of the BA in Sociology is to provide undergraduate students (both majors and non-majors) with broad knowledge of the theoretical concepts, empirical research findings, and methodological approaches of the discipline of sociology, with an emphasis on theory and research related to social inequality. As part of this program, sociology majors should gain mastery of these concepts, findings, and approaches central to sociology, as well as develop basic skills in empirical analysis and professional communication.

At UT Dallas, sociology majors are encouraged to go beyond scholarly study to explore ways that sociology can be utilized in corporations, government agencies, or voluntary organizations. Sociology graduates of the University have pursued careers or graduate study in a variety of areas including policy research, social services, business, law, education, law enforcement, and other social sciences.

Bachelor of Arts in Sociology

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)¹

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

FACG> epps-sociology-ba

Professor: Richard K. Scotch, Sheryl L. Skaggs

Associate Professor: Sarah Maxwell

Assistant Professor: Brenda Gambol Gavigan

Professor of Instruction: Carol Cirulli Lanham

Assistant Professor of Instruction: Galen Dickey-Laprocido

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours²

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

[COMM 1311](#) Survey of Oral and Technology-based Communication

[RHET 1302](#) Rhetoric

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[MATH 1306](#) College Algebra for the Non-Scientist

[MATH 1314](#) College Algebra

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses (see advisor)

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

[GOVT 2305](#) American National Government

[GOVT 2306](#) State and Local Government

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see

advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

[SOC 1301](#) Introduction to Sociology^{3, 4}_{— —}

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

[EPPS 2301](#) Research Design in the Social and Policy Sciences^{3, 4}_{— —}

[EPPS 2302](#) Methods of Quantitative Analysis in the Social and Policy Sciences^{3, 4}_{— —}

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses (see advisor)

II. Major Requirements: 48 semester credit hours

Major Preparatory Courses: 3 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

[ECON 2301](#) Principles of Macroeconomics

or [ECON 2302](#) Principles of Microeconomics

[EPPS 2301](#) Research Design in the Social and Policy Sciences^{3, 4}_{— —}

[EPPS 2302](#) Methods of Quantitative Analysis in the Social and Policy Sciences^{3, 4}_{— —}

[SOC 1301](#) Introduction to Sociology^{3, 4}_{— —}

Major Core Courses: 18 semester credit hours

[SOC 3303](#) Classical Social Theory

[SOC 4305](#) Applied Data Analysis

[SOC 3381](#) Field Research Methods

[SOC 4302](#) Class, Status, and Power

[SOC 4306](#) Advanced Sociological Research

Choose one course from the following:

[SOC 4385](#) Global Health and Society

[SOC 4388](#) Religions in Global Societies

Major Related Courses: 27 semester credit hours

18 semester credit hours of upper-division Sociology courses

9 semester credit hours Major and Related electives⁵

III. Elective Requirements: 30 semester credit hours

This requirement may be satisfied with lower- and upper-division courses from any field of study.

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

Minors

Students must take a minimum of 18 semester credit hours for the minor, 12 of which must be upper-division semester credit hours. Students who take a minor will be expected to meet the normal prerequisites in courses making up the minor, and should maintain a minimum GPA of 2.000 on a 4.00 scale (C average). Semester credit hours may not be used to satisfy both the major and minor requirements; however, free elective semester credit hours or major preparatory classes may be used to satisfy the minor.

Minor in Public Health

18 semester credit hours

Required Courses: 9 semester credit hours

[SOC 4369](#) Public Health and Society

[SOC 4372](#) Health and Illness

[SOC 4385](#) Global Health and Society

Electives: 9 semester credit hours

Any three (3) of the following courses will be accepted as electives for the minor. Other courses will be considered on a case-by-case basis by the program coordinator.

[ECON 3330](#) Economics of Health

[GEOG 3357](#) Spatial Dimensions of Health and Disease

[GEOG 3372](#) Population and Development

[HIST 3328](#) History and Philosophy of Science and Medicine

[HLTH 1322](#) Human Nutrition

[HLTH 3301](#) Issues in Geriatric Healthcare

[HLTH 3305](#) The U.S. Healthcare System

[HLTH 3310](#) Health Care Issues: Global Perspectives

[HLTH 4380](#) Special Topics in Healthcare

[HMGH 3301](#) Introduction to Healthcare Management

[PSY 4328](#) Health Psychology

[PSY 4346](#) Human Sexuality

[SOC 4357](#) Drugs, Alcohol and Society

[SOC 4371](#) Mental Health and Illness

[SOC 4372](#) Health and Illness

[SPAN 3330](#) Medical Spanish

Minor in Sociology

18 semester credit hours

Required Courses: 9 semester credit hours

[SOC 1301](#) Introduction to Sociology

[SOC 3303](#) Classical Social Theory

[SOC 4302](#) Class, Status, and Power

Upper-Division Courses: 9 semester credit hours

Any upper-division classes with a SOC prefix with the exception of [SOC 4V97](#), [SOC 4V98](#), and [SOC 4V99](#).

1. Incoming freshmen must enroll and complete requirements of UNIV 1010 and the corresponding school-related freshman seminar course. Students, including transfer students,

who complete their core curriculum at UT Dallas must take UNIV 2020.

2. Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.

3. A Major requirement that also fulfills a Core Curriculum requirement. Semester credit hours are counted in Core Curriculum.

4. Prerequisite course to upper-division SOC courses.

5. Most students take upper-division SOC courses. However, subject to advisor approval, courses from other disciplines may be used to satisfy this requirement.

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